



Jose Adrian Cruz-Garcia

Founder & President | Cruz Landscaping & Design Inc.

Jose Adrian Cruz-Garcia's career in construction began at just 15 years old in Lincoln Dell Wedd Homes, California, with a lawn mower and a willingness to work.

What started with basic mowing and yard maintenance grew into maintaining as many as 30 properties every weekend. At the time, Adrian didn't know that those early weekends would become the foundation of a career in landscaping, concrete construction, leadership, and eventually business ownership.

His path was not traditional. Adrian did not finish high school and instead enrolled in Job Corps in Sacramento, where he earned his GED and was required to select two trades to pursue. He chose landscaping because it was the work he already knew, and concrete because masonry and concrete were part of his family background—his father was a mason by trade.

Ironically, concrete was something Adrian never imagined himself doing professionally. Growing up, his father would bring him along to help, often putting him behind a wheelbarrow. Adrian hated the work at the time and believed he would never become part of that world.

That changed at Job Corps.

One of his concrete instructors Doc. Pickett and mentors recognized his potential early and told Adrian that concrete was the trade he needed to pursue. The more Adrian learned, the more he discovered a passion for the same work he once wanted nothing to do with.

After earning his GED, Adrian was given an opportunity that would change the direction of his career. His instructor, who was involved with the 400 local union in Sacramento, helped him begin his path as a union apprentice.

From there, Adrian committed himself to the concrete trade.

He completed a three-year apprenticeship while gaining extensive field experience in the union construction industry. During his apprenticeship, he competed in a national apprenticeship competition bringing together skilled apprentices from national unions across the country. Adrian earned **second place**, an accomplishment that reinforced both his ability and his commitment to the craft.

After completing his apprenticeship, he continued moving through the ranks—from journeyman-level responsibilities to lead man, and eventually foreman, where he was trusted to run work, coordinate crews, and take responsibility for getting projects completed correctly.

Over approximately 10 to 11 years in the union construction industry, Adrian developed his skills not only as a concrete craftsman but also as a field leader. His experience included several years working for a major contractor in the El Dorado Hills area, exposing him to larger construction operations and the standards required to successfully execute professional commercial work.

But the next chapter of his career began through landscaping.

A landscaper Adrian helped with side jobs offered to sponsor him in pursuing his contractor license. Although landscaping was not where most of his professional construction career had taken place, it was where his working life had originally begun.

Getting licensed was not easy. Adrian took the licensing exam three times before passing.

Instead of allowing those unsuccessful attempts to stop him, he kept coming back until he earned his license. Because the opportunity originated through landscaping and his C-27 license first and two years later acquired the C-8 license, the company became **Cruz Landscaping & Design Inc.**

That decision marked the beginning of a completely different education.

Adrian already knew how to work. He knew concrete. He knew landscaping. He knew how to lead crews and build projects.

What he had to learn was how to build a business.

The first years of Cruz Landscaping & Design Inc. required Adrian to learn the other side of construction: estimating, bidding, sales, contracts, scheduling, hiring, managing employees, equipment, overhead, customer relationships, and the countless responsibilities that come with owning a construction company.

Six years into that journey, the company is entering a new stage.

Adrian is now focused less on doing everything himself and more on **building a team, developing leaders, creating systems, and delegating responsibility** so the company can grow beyond what one person can accomplish.

At the center of that growth are two principles that have followed him throughout his career: **integrity and quality.**

Today, Cruz Landscaping & Design Inc. continues to develop its landscaping and concrete capabilities while expanding into commercial and prevailing-wage construction. The company has begun gaining experience on prevailing-wage commercial projects and is signatory with **Laborers Local 185**, representing an important step toward Adrian's larger vision for the business.

His long-term goal is to establish Cruz Landscaping & Design Inc. as a strong union contractor capable of performing larger commercial and public works projects while creating real career opportunities for the people who become part of the company.

For Adrian, building the company is no longer only about his own career.

It is about developing apprentices into skilled craftsmen, craftsmen into leaders, and leaders into foremen who can carry the company's standards into the field. It is about creating an organization where employees have an opportunity to build careers while clients receive work performed with professionalism, integrity, and pride.

From mowing lawns at 15 years old, to earning his GED through Job Corps, to becoming a union concrete apprentice, placing second in a national apprenticeship competition, becoming a foreman, and eventually becoming a licensed contractor and business owner, Adrian's career has been built one opportunity at a time.

Some opportunities were given to him by mentors who saw potential in him.

Others required failing, learning, and trying again.

Today, Adrian is working to do the same thing for the next generation—building a company where hard work can become a trade, a trade can become a career, and a career can become an opportunity to lead.

Cruz Landscaping & Design Inc.

Built from the trade. Driven by integrity. Growing through opportunity.